

OPERATIONS GUIDE

Set Up classlift.com and Redirect It to classlift.ca

Cloudflare Free Plan • Permanent 301 redirect • Path and query preservation

Recommended outcome Keep classlift.ca as the primary Canadian website. Route classlift.com and www.classlift.com through Cloudflare and permanently redirect visitors to the matching page on classlift.ca.

What this guide will configure

- Add classlift.com to a free Cloudflare account.
- Move authoritative DNS to Cloudflare without losing existing email records.
- Create proxied DNS records for classlift.com and www.classlift.com.
- Create one 301 redirect rule that preserves page paths and query strings.
- Verify HTTPS, redirect behavior, and common failure conditions.

Final traffic flow

classlift.com/* → Cloudflare edge → 301 → classlift.ca/same-path

Visitor enters	Visitor reaches
https://classlift.com/	https://classlift.ca/
https://www.classlift.com/pricing.html	https://classlift.ca/pricing.html
https://classlift.com/contact.html?source=email	https://classlift.ca/contact.html?source=email

Before you begin

Important Changing nameservers affects every DNS service for classlift.com, including email. Take screenshots or export the current DNS zone before making changes.

You will need

- Login access to the registrar where classlift.com was purchased.
- Access to the email address used for the Cloudflare account.
- A copy of all current DNS records, especially MX and TXT records.
- Permission to change the domain's authoritative nameservers.

DNS records that must be protected

Type	Usually used for	What to do
MX	Receiving email	Copy exactly; do not delete unless confirmed obsolete.
TXT	SPF, DKIM, DMARC, verification	Copy the complete value exactly, including punctuation.
CNAME	Websites and service verification	Identify whether it is still needed before replacing it.
A / AAAA	Website hosting	Check whether it conflicts with the new redirect-only records.

Step 1 — Create and secure the Cloudflare account

1. Open <https://dash.cloudflare.com/> and create an account using an email address you control.
2. Verify the account email address.
3. Enable two-factor authentication under the account profile or authentication settings.

Step 2 — Add classlift.com

4. In the Cloudflare dashboard, choose Add a domain, Add site, or Onboard a domain. Cloudflare may use slightly different wording.
5. Enter classlift.com only. Do not enter https:// and do not enter www.
6. Choose the Free plan and continue.
7. Allow Cloudflare to scan the current DNS records.
8. Compare the imported records with the copy made before starting. Restore any missing email records before continuing.

Step 3 — Change nameservers at the registrar

Cloudflare will assign two nameservers unique to classlift.com, similar to:

```
example-one.ns.cloudflare.com
example-two.ns.cloudflare.com
```

Do not copy the examples Use only the two nameservers displayed inside your own Cloudflare dashboard.

9. Log in to the registrar where classlift.com was purchased.
10. Open Domain Settings, Nameservers, or DNS Management.
11. Choose the option to use custom nameservers.
12. Replace the existing nameservers with the two nameservers assigned by Cloudflare.
13. Save the change and return to Cloudflare.
14. Select Check nameservers now and wait until the zone status becomes Active.

DNSSEC note If the registrar reports a DNSSEC conflict, follow Cloudflare's instruction to disable the old DNSSEC configuration before changing nameservers. Re-enable DNSSEC from Cloudflare after activation if desired.

Step 4 — Create redirect-only DNS records

After classlift.com shows **Active**, open DNS → Records in the classlift.com zone.

Type	Name	Target	Proxy	TTL
A	@	192.0.2.1	Proxied	Auto
CNAME	www	classlift.com	Proxied	Auto

- The orange cloud must be enabled for both records; this is the Proxied state.
- 192.0.2.1 is a reserved documentation address. Cloudflare should execute the redirect before any request reaches that address.
- Remove or replace conflicting @ or www web records only after confirming they are not required.
- Do not remove MX, SPF, DKIM, DMARC, or unrelated verification records.

Step 5 — Create the 301 redirect rule

Inside the **classlift.com** zone, open one of these paths depending on the current Cloudflare interface:

Rules → Redirect Rules → Create rule

Rules → Overview → Redirect Rules → Single Redirects → Create rule

Rule configuration

Field	Value
Rule name	Redirect classlift.com to classlift.ca
Match type	Custom filter expression
Incoming request expression	(http.host eq "classlift.com") or (http.host eq "www.classlift.com")
Redirect type	Dynamic
Destination expression	concat("https://classlift.ca", http.request.uri.path)
Status code	301 — Permanent Redirect
Query string	Preserve query string: enabled

What the destination expression means

```
concat("https://classlift.ca", http.request.uri.path)
```

The expression joins the destination host **https://classlift.ca** with the visitor's original path. It prevents every request from being sent only to the home page.

Original request	Original path	Destination
classlift.com/	/	classlift.ca/
classlift.com/pricing.html	/pricing.html	classlift.ca/pricing.html
classlift.com/contact.html	/contact.html	classlift.ca/contact.html

About #pricing The part after # is a browser fragment and is not sent to Cloudflare. When the redirect destination does not supply a different fragment, the browser normally retains it.

Step 6 — Verify HTTPS and redirect behavior

15. Wait for Cloudflare to issue edge certificates for classlift.com and www.classlift.com.
16. Open a private or incognito browser window to avoid cached redirect results.
17. Test HTTP and HTTPS for both the root and www hostnames.
18. Test a real path, a query string, and the pricing-page fragment.

Browser test checklist

- <http://classlift.com> redirects to <https://classlift.ca/>
- <https://classlift.com> redirects without a certificate warning
- <https://www.classlift.com> redirects correctly
- <https://classlift.com/pricing.html> redirects to the matching .ca page
- <https://classlift.com/pricing.html?source=test> retains ?source=test
- <https://classlift.com/pricing.html#pricing> opens the pricing section on classlift.ca

PowerShell verification

```
curl.exe -I https://classlift.com/
curl.exe -I https://www.classlift.com/pricing.html
curl.exe -I "https://classlift.com/contact.html?source=test"
```

A correct response should include:

```
HTTP/2 301
location: https://classlift.ca/pricing.html
```

Troubleshooting

Problem	Checks and corrective action
Redirect Rules is missing	Confirm that you selected the classlift.com website zone, not the account home page. The zone should show Active.
Cloudflare says nameservers are pending	Confirm that both assigned Cloudflare nameservers replaced the old nameservers at the registrar. Allow time for propagation.
Redirect rule does not run	Confirm that @ and www DNS records exist and show the orange Proxied cloud. Review the hostname expression.
Every request goes to the home page	Use the dynamic concat expression instead of a fixed destination URL.
Query string disappears	Enable Preserve query string in the redirect rule.
Email stops working	Restore the original MX and email-related TXT records. DNS web redirects should not require changing those records.

Problem	Checks and corrective action
Browser shows the old result	Test in a private window, clear DNS/browser cache, or use curl.exe -I to inspect the current response.
HTTPS certificate warning	Wait for Cloudflare edge-certificate issuance and confirm both hostnames are proxied.

Completion checklist

- Cloudflare account has two-factor authentication enabled.
- classlift.com shows Active in Cloudflare.
- Existing MX and email TXT records remain intact.
- @ and www DNS records are Proxied.
- The 301 redirect rule is deployed.
- Paths and query strings are preserved.
- HTTP, HTTPS, root, www, and pricing-page tests pass.
- classlift.ca remains the canonical primary website.

Operational recommendation Keep classlift.com registered and renewed even while classlift.ca remains primary. Review the redirect after any DNS-provider or website-hosting change.